

The Road Not Taken

SUMMARY

The poem, 'The Road Not Taken' is written by a prolific writer Robert Frost. The poem is about making choices in life. The poet was going through woods where the road diverged into two. He looks down on one up to the point where it bent under the bushes. The poet chooses the other road. It is grassy and only few have used it. The poet thinks that his choice is good. But later he finds out that both the roads have been worn out equally. That morning both the roads are covered with leaves and no traveller has stepped over them. The poet decides to keep the first road for another day though there was little chance of his returning back. The poet imagines a time in future when he would recall what had made him a different person. He will then think that his choice had made the difference.

Q1. Where does the traveller find himself? What problem does he face?

Ans: The traveller finds himself in a forest at a place where the road diverges into two. He is confused as he cannot decide which road to take. Both the roads are equally attractive but he can only choose one.

Q2. What is the difference between the two roads as described by the poet in stanzas two and three?

Ans: Both the roads are equally attractive, covered with yellow leaves. The only difference is that one of the roads seems to be less travelled by.

Q3. Which road does the poet choose? Does he regret his decision?

Ans: The poet chooses the less travelled road and leaves the worn out road for some other time. No, the poet does not explicitly regret his decision in The Road Not Taken. Instead, he reflects thoughtfully on the choice he made, acknowledging its significance, but without expressing clear regret.

Q4. Find the rhyme scheme of the poem.

Ans: The rhyme scheme of the poem is abaab

Q5. Explain the following phrases:

a. A Yellow Wood:

Yellow wood indicates a forest during the Autumn season During autumn, leaves of the trees turn yellow giving the entire forest a yellow look.

b. Bent in the undergrowth:

It indicates the bend at the end of the road where the road disappears in the dense growth of trees and bushes.

c. Trodden black:

It means the leaves had been trampled under the feet of the travellers turning them black